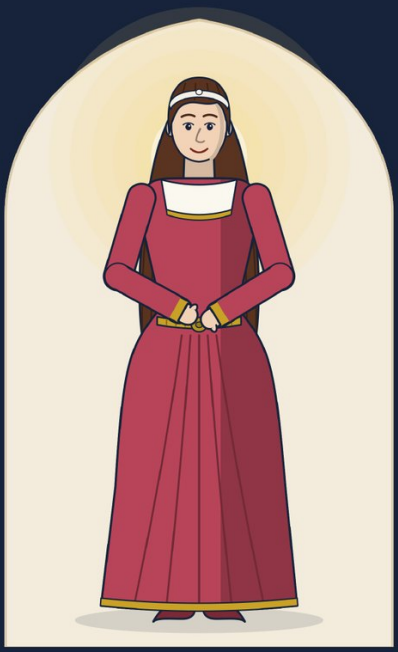
Janjua's ENGLISH LIT NOTES



Romeo and Juliet

WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE

EXAM EDITION

TEXT · MODERN ENGLISH · MODEL ANSWERS

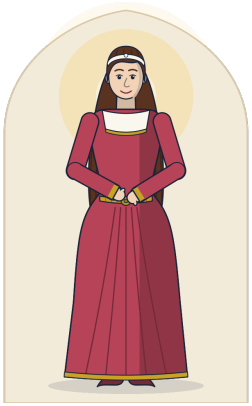
BY QAISAR IQBAL JANJUA

Janjua's ENGLISH LIT NOTES

Romeo and Juliet

WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE

EXAM EDITION



Every line with modern English · every scene · model answers

BY QAISAR IQBAL JANJUA

A Note from the Author

Dear student,

If you have opened this book, you probably have an exam coming, and a play that everyone thinks they know. Romeo and Juliet is the most famous love story in the world, but it is also a fast, crowded, surprising play: street fights, a masked feast, a secret wedding, two deaths in one afternoon, a sleeping drug and a tomb. None of it needs to frighten you. You need to know what is happening, why the characters act as they do, and how to write about it well.

That is what this book is for. Every line of the play has its meaning in plain modern English printed with it, so you always know what is being said. After each scene you will find the answers examiners look for, written the way a good answer should be written: clear, to the point, and the right length for the marks.

You do not need to read it from cover to cover. Begin with Questions That Come, find the question that worries you most, and go straight to it. In your last week, stay with Practice and Revise.

I have checked every line and every answer, and I have tried my best to keep this book free of errors. If you do find one, please tell me at qaisar@janjuaslitnotes.com, and I will put it right.

Study well, and walk into that exam with confidence. I am cheering for you.

Qaisar Iqbal Janjua

JANJUA'S ENGLISH LIT NOTES

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The Balcony Scene: "Wherefore Art Thou Romeo?"

PROLOGUE TO ACT 2; ACT 2, SCENES 1 AND 2 · CAPULET'S ORCHARD

Romeo climbs into Capulet's orchard and hears Juliet confess her love at her window. They exchange vows and plan to marry.

Unit 5 · Prologue to Act 2 (14 lines); Act 2, Scenes 1 and 2 (42 and 190 lines) · Essays 1, 2, 6, 9, 10

Romeo, drawn for this book from the play.

1. Romeo's first words to the window: "It is the east, and Juliet is the sun!" (2.2.3). LIGHT LOVE
2. Juliet sees that the feud is only a name: "'Tis but thy name that is my enemy;" (2.2.38). FEUD LOVE
3. Juliet fears the speed: "It is too rash, too unadvised, too sudden," (2.2.118). TIME

EXAMINERS ASK

What is the significance of the balcony scene in Romeo and Juliet? **Answer: Critical note, page 137**

What does Juliet's "wherefore art thou Romeo?" speech show about her? **Answer: Short answer 2, page 139**

Explain lines 116 to 124 of Act 2, Scene 2 with reference to the context. **Answer: Context answer, page 141**

✓ **In one night two strangers promise to marry, and Juliet leads the way.**

In this unit: **Text 115** · **Critical note 137** · **Short answers 139** · **Context answer 141** · **Objective questions 142**

CONTEXT

The balcony that is not there. Everyone calls Act 2, Scene 2 the balcony scene, but the word "balcony" is not in the play. The stage direction says only, "Juliet appears above at a window." Romeo stands below in Capulet's orchard, having climbed its high walls. Juliet warns him that the place is "death, considering who thou art," (2.2.64) if her kinsmen find him. The height between them pictures the distance their families have set between them, and the night that hides them is both their protection and their danger.

The text

The Prologue to Act 2 ACT 2, SCENE 0 · LINES 1 TO 14

PROLOGUE

Enter Chorus.

CHORUS

Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie,
Now Romeo's old desire lies on its deathbed,

And young affection gapes to be his heir;
And a new love is eager to take its place;

That fair for which love groan'd for and would die,
That beauty for whom love groaned and would have died,

With tender Juliet match'd, is now not fair.
Compared with tender Juliet, is not beautiful now.

Now Romeo is beloved and loves again,
Now Romeo is loved and loves in return,

Alike bewitched by the charm of looks,
Both of them bewitched by the charm of looks,

But to his foe supposed he must complain,
But he must plead his love to one he thinks his enemy,

8 And she steal love's sweet bait from fearful hooks:
And she must steal love's sweet bait from dangerous hooks:

9 Being held a foe, he may not have access
Since he is thought an enemy, he cannot get near her

10 To breathe such vows as lovers use to swear;
To speak the kind of vows that lovers usually swear;

11 And she as much in love, her means much less
And she, just as much in love, has even less means

12 To meet her new beloved any where:
Of meeting her new love anywhere:

13 But passion lends them power, time means, to meet,
But passion gives them power, and time gives them ways, to meet,

14 Tempering extremities with extreme sweet.
Softening great dangers with great sweetness.

Exit.

WORDS

1 old desire: **Romeo's love for Rosaline** · **2** gapes: **longs, is eager** · **14** Tempering extremities: **softening great hardships**

Mercutio and Benvolio look for Romeo

ACT 2, SCENE 1 · LINES 1 TO 42

A LANE BY THE WALL OF CAPULET'S ORCHARD.

Enter ROMEO, alone.

ROMEO

1 Can I go forward when my heart is here?
Can I go on when my heart is here?

2 Turn back, dull earth, and find thy centre out.
Turn back, dull body, and find your heart, your centre.

He climbs the wall, and leaps down within it.

Enter BENVOLIO with MERCUTIO.

BENVOLIO

Romeo! my cousin Romeo!
Romeo! My cousin Romeo!

MERCUTIO

He is wise;
He is sensible;

And, on my life, hath stol'n him home to bed.
And, on my life, he has slipped home to bed.

BENVOLIO

He ran this way, and leap'd this orchard wall:
He ran this way and jumped over this orchard wall:

Call, good Mercutio.
Call him, good Mercutio.

MERCUTIO

Nay, I'll conjure too.
No, I will call up his spirit too.

Romeo! humours! madman! passion! lover!
Romeo! Moods! Madman! Passion! Lover!

Appear thou in the likeness of a sigh:
Appear in the shape of a sigh:

Speak but one rhyme, and I am satisfied;
Speak just one rhyme, and I will be satisfied;

Cry but 'ay me!' pronounce but 'love' and 'dove;'
Just cry "Oh dear!", just say "love" and "dove";

Speak to my gossip Venus one fair word,
Speak one kind word to my old friend Venus,

One nick-name for her purblind son and heir,
One nickname for her half-blind son and heir,

13 Young Adam Cupid, he that shot so trim
Young Adam Cupid, the one who shot so accurately

14 When King Cophetua loved the beggar-maid!
When King Cophetua fell in love with the beggar girl!

15 He heareth not, he stirreth not, he moveth not;
He does not hear, he does not stir, he does not move;

16 The ape is dead, and I must conjure him.
The fool is dead, and I must raise his spirit.

17 I conjure thee by Rosaline's bright eyes,
I call you up by Rosaline's bright eyes,

18 By her high forehead and her scarlet lip,
By her high forehead and her red lips,

19 By her fine foot, straight leg and quivering thigh,
By her fine foot, straight leg and quivering thigh,

20 And the demesnes that there adjacent lie,
And the regions that lie next to them,

21 That in thy likeness thou appear to us!
Appear to us in your own shape!

WORDS

2 dull earth: **his body, made of earth** · **2** centre: **his heart: Juliet** · **6** conjure: **call up a spirit by magic** · **11** gossip: **old friend** · **12** purblind: **half-blind** · **14** King Cophetua: **a king in a ballad who married a beggar** · **16** The ape: **the fool (said fondly)** · **20** demesnes: **lands, regions (a sexual joke)**

BENVOLIO

22 An if he hear thee, thou wilt anger him.
If he hears you, you will make him angry.

MERCUTIO

23 This cannot anger him: 'twould anger him
This cannot make him angry: it would make him angry

24 To raise a spirit in his mistress' circle
To raise a spirit in his mistress's magic circle,

Of some strange nature, letting it there stand
A strange one, letting it stand there

Till she had laid it and conjured it down;
Until she had calmed it and made it go down;

That were some spite: my invocation
That would be an insult to him: my spell

Is fair and honest, and in his mistress' name
Is fair and honest, and in his mistress's name

I conjure only but to raise up him.
I am only calling him up.

BENVOLIO

Come, he hath hid himself among these trees,
Come, he has hidden himself among these trees,

To be consorted with the humorous night:
To keep company with the damp, moody night:

Blind is his love, and best befits the dark.
His love is blind, and the dark suits it best.

MERCUTIO

If love be blind, love cannot hit the mark.
If love is blind, love cannot hit the target.

Now will he sit under a medlar-tree,
Now he will sit under a medlar tree,

And wish his mistress were that kind of fruit
And wish his mistress were the kind of fruit

As maids call medlars when they laugh alone.
That girls call medlars when they laugh alone together.

O, Romeo, that she were, O, that she were
Oh, Romeo, if only she were, oh, if only she were

An open et cetera, thou a poperin pear!
An open et cetera, and you a pear from Poperinghe!

Romeo, good night: I'll to my truckle-bed;
Romeo, good night: I am going to my little bed;

40 This field-bed is too cold for me to sleep:
This bed in the open is too cold for me to sleep in:

41 Come, shall we go?
Come, shall we go?

BENVOLIO

Go then, for 'tis in vain
Go then, for it is useless

42 To seek him here that means not to be found.
To look here for someone who does not want to be found.

Exeunt.

WORDS

24 circle: **a magic circle (a sexual joke)** · **31** humorous: **damp; also moody** · **34** medlar-tree: **tree with a fruit used in sexual jokes** · **38** poperin pear: **a pear from Poperinghe (a sexual joke)** · **39** truckle-bed: **a low bed on wheels**

Romeo below Juliet's window

ACT 2, SCENE 2 · LINES 1 TO 106

CAPULET'S ORCHARD.

Enter ROMEO.

ROMEO

1 He jests at scars that never felt a wound.
He jokes about scars who never felt a wound.

Juliet appears above at a window.

2 But, soft! what light through yonder window breaks?
But wait! What light breaks through that window over there?

3 It is the east, and Juliet is the sun!
It is the east, and Juliet is the sun!

4 Arise, fair sun, and kill the envious moon,
Rise, beautiful sun, and kill the jealous moon,

Who is already sick and pale with grief,
Who is already sick and pale with grief

That thou her maid art far more fair than she:
That you, her servant, are far more beautiful than she is:

Be not her maid, since she is envious;
Do not be her servant, since she is jealous;

Her vestal livery is but sick and green,
Her virgin's uniform is just sickly and green,

And none but fools do wear it; cast it off.
And no one but fools wears it; throw it off.

It is my lady; O, it is my love!
It is my lady; oh, it is my love!

O, that she knew she were!
Oh, if only she knew she was!

She speaks, yet she says nothing: what of that?
She speaks, yet she says nothing: what does that matter?

Her eye discourses, I will answer it.
Her eye speaks; I will answer it.

I am too bold, 'tis not to me she speaks:
I am too bold, it is not to me she is speaking:

Two of the fairest stars in all the heaven,
Two of the most beautiful stars in all the heavens,

Having some business, do intreat her eyes
Having some business elsewhere, beg her eyes

To twinkle in their spheres till they return.
To twinkle in their places until they return.

What if her eyes were there, they in her head?
What if her eyes were up there, and the stars in her head?

The brightness of her cheek would shame those stars,
The brightness of her cheek would put those stars to shame,

As daylight doth a lamp; her eyes in heaven
As daylight does a lamp; her eyes in heaven

Would through the airy region stream so bright
Would shine so brightly through the sky

That birds would sing and think it were not night.
That birds would sing and think it was not night.

See, how she leans her cheek upon her hand!
Look how she leans her cheek on her hand!

O, that I were a glove upon that hand,
Oh, if only I were a glove on that hand,

25 That I might touch that cheek!
So that I might touch that cheek!

JULIET

Ay me!
Oh dear!

ROMEO

She speaks:
She speaks:

O, speak again, bright angel! for thou art
Oh, speak again, bright angel! For you are

As glorious to this night, being o'er my head,
As glorious to this night, being above my head,

As is a winged messenger of heaven
As a winged messenger from heaven is

Unto the white-upturned wondering eyes
To the amazed eyes, turned up to show their whites,

30 Of mortals that fall back to gaze on him,
Of human beings who lean back to stare at him,

When he bestrides the lazy-pacing clouds
When he rides on the slow-moving clouds

And sails upon the bosom of the air.
And sails on the breast of the air.

WORDS

1 He jests at scars that never felt a wound: **only those never hurt mock pain** · **8** vestal livery: **the uniform of a virgin** · **8** sick and green: **pale and green-faced, as in anaemia** · **17** spheres: **orbits (stars were thought fixed in spheres)** · **28** winged messenger: **an angel**

JULIET

33 O Romeo, Romeo! wherefore art thou Romeo?
Oh Romeo, Romeo! Why are you Romeo?

34 Deny thy father and refuse thy name;
Reject your father and refuse your name;

35 Or, if thou wilt not, be but sworn my love,
Or, if you will not, just swear you love me,

36 And I'll no longer be a Capulet.
And I will no longer be a Capulet.

ROMEO

Aside

37 Shall I hear more, or shall I speak at this?
Shall I listen to more, or shall I speak now?

JULIET

38 'Tis but thy name that is my enemy;
It is only your name that is my enemy;

39 Thou art thyself, though not a Montague.
You would be yourself even if you were not a Montague.

40 What's Montague? it is nor hand, nor foot,
What is a Montague? It is not a hand, or a foot,

41 Nor arm, nor face, nor any other part
Or an arm, or a face, or any other part

42 Belonging to a man. O, be some other name!
Of a man. Oh, be some other name!

43 What's in a name? that which we call a rose
What is in a name? The flower we call a rose

44 By any other name would smell as sweet;
Would smell just as sweet if it had any other name;

45 So Romeo would, were he not Romeo call'd,
So Romeo, if he were not called Romeo,

46 Retain that dear perfection which he owes
Would keep the dear perfection that he has

47 Without that title. Romeo, doff thy name,
Without that name. Romeo, throw off your name,

48 And for thy name, which is no part of thee,
And in return for your name, which is no part of you,

49 Take all myself.
Take all of me.

ROMEO

I take thee at thy word:
I take you at your word:

50 Call me but love, and I'll be new baptized;
Just call me love, and I will be baptised again;

51 Henceforth I never will be Romeo.
From now on I will never be Romeo.

WORDS

33 wherefore: **why (not where)** · **46** owes: **owns, has** · **47** doff: **take off, throw away**

JULIET

52 What man art thou, that, thus bescreen'd in night,
What man are you, who, hidden like this in the night,

53 So stumblest on my counsel?
Stumble on my private thoughts?

ROMEO

By a name
By a name

I know not how to tell thee who I am:
I do not know how to tell you who I am:

My name, dear saint, is hateful to myself,
My name, dear saint, is hateful to me,

Because it is an enemy to thee;
Because it is an enemy to you;

Had I it written, I would tear the word.
If I had it written down, I would tear up the word.

JULIET

My ears have yet not drunk a hundred words
My ears have not yet heard a hundred words

Of thy tongue's uttering, yet I know the sound:
Spoken by your tongue, yet I know the sound:

Art thou not Romeo, and a Montague?
Are you not Romeo, and a Montague?

ROMEO

Neither, fair maid, if either thee dislike.
Neither, fair girl, if you dislike either.

JULIET

How camest thou hither, tell me, and wherefore?
How did you come here, tell me, and why?

The orchard walls are high and hard to climb,
The orchard walls are high and hard to climb,

And the place death, considering who thou art,
And this place means death, considering who you are,

If any of my kinsmen find thee here.
If any of my family find you here.

ROMEO

With love's light wings did I o'er-perch these walls,
I flew over these walls on love's light wings,

67 For stony limits cannot hold love out:
For stone walls cannot keep love out:

68 And what love can do, that dares love attempt;
And whatever love can do, love dares to try;

69 Therefore thy kinsmen are no let to me.
So your family are no obstacle to me.

WORDS

52 bescreen'd: **hidden** · **53** counsel: **private thoughts** · **69** let: **obstacle**

JULIET

70 If they do see thee, they will murder thee.
If they see you, they will murder you.

ROMEO

71 Alack, there lies more peril in thine eye
Oh, there is more danger in your eyes

72 Than twenty of their swords: look thou but sweet,
Than in twenty of their swords: just look kindly at me,

73 And I am proof against their enmity.
And I am armoured against their hatred.

JULIET

74 I would not for the world they saw thee here.
I would not have them see you here for the world.

ROMEO

75 I have night's cloak to hide me from their eyes;
I have the cloak of night to hide me from their eyes;

76 And but thou love me, let them find me here:
And if you do not love me, let them find me here:

77 My life were better ended by their hate,
It would be better to end my life through their hate

78 Than death prorogued, wanting of thy love.
Than to put off death while lacking your love.

JULIET

By whose direction found'st thou out this place?
Who showed you the way to find this place?

ROMEO

By love, that first did prompt me to inquire;
Love, who first urged me to ask;

He lent me counsel, and I lent him eyes.
He gave me advice, and I lent him my eyes.

I am no pilot; yet, wert thou as far
I am not a ship's pilot; yet if you were as far away

As that vast shore wash'd with the farthest sea,
As the vast shore washed by the farthest sea,

I would adventure for such merchandise.
I would risk the voyage for such a treasure.

JULIET

Thou know'st the mask of night is on my face,
You know the mask of night is on my face,

Else would a maiden blush bepaint my cheek
Or else a girl's blush would colour my cheek

For that which thou hast heard me speak to-night.
Because of what you have heard me say tonight.

Fain would I dwell on form, fain, fain deny
I would gladly keep to good manners, gladly, gladly deny

What I have spoke: but farewell compliment!
What I have said: but goodbye to formal manners!

Dost thou love me? I know thou wilt say 'Ay,'
Do you love me? I know you will say "Yes,"

And I will take thy word: yet, if thou swear'st,
And I will take your word: yet, if you swear it,

Thou mayst prove false: at lovers' perjuries,
You may prove false: at lovers' broken promises,

They say, Jove laughs. O gentle Romeo,
They say, Jove laughs. Oh gentle Romeo,

If thou dost love, pronounce it faithfully:
If you do love me, say so faithfully:

Or if thou think'st I am too quickly won,
Or if you think I am won too quickly,

I'll frown and be perverse and say thee nay,
I will frown and be difficult and say no to you,

So thou wilt woo; but else, not for the world.
So that you will court me; but otherwise, not for the world.

In truth, fair Montague, I am too fond;
Truly, fair Montague, I am too much in love;

And therefore thou mayst think my 'haviour light:
And so you may think my behaviour shameless:

But trust me, gentleman, I'll prove more true
But trust me, sir, I will prove more faithful

Than those that have more cunning to be strange.
Than those who are clever enough to play hard to get.

I should have been more strange, I must confess,
I should have been more distant, I must admit,

But that thou overheard'st, ere I was ware,
But you overheard, before I knew you were there,

My true love's passion: therefore pardon me,
My true love's passion: so forgive me,

And not impute this yielding to light love,
And do not put down my giving in to shallow love,

Which the dark night hath so discovered.
Which the dark night has revealed like this.

WORDS

73 proof: **armoured, protected** · **78** prorogued: **put off** · **84** adventure: **risk a voyage, as a merchant** · **88** dwell on form: **keep to good manners** ·

89 compliment: **polite formality** · **93** Jove: **king of the Roman gods** · **99** light: **shameless, too easily won** · **101** strange: **distant, hard to win**

Vows, the Nurse's call and a plan to marry

ACT 2, SCENE 2 · LINES 107 TO 190

ROMEO

Lady, by yonder blessed moon I swear,
Lady, I swear by that blessed moon up there,

That tips with silver all these fruit-tree tops,—
Which tips all these fruit-tree tops with silver—

JULIET

O, swear not by the moon, th' inconstant moon,
Oh, do not swear by the moon, the changeable moon,

That monthly changes in her circled orb,
Which changes every month in its circling path,

Lest that thy love prove likewise variable.
In case your love proves just as changeable.

ROMEO

What shall I swear by?
What shall I swear by?

JULIET

Do not swear at all;
Do not swear at all;

Or, if thou wilt, swear by thy gracious self,
Or, if you must, swear by your gracious self,

Which is the god of my idolatry,
Which is the god I worship,

And I'll believe thee.
And I will believe you.

ROMEO

If my heart's dear love—
If my heart's dear love—

JULIET

Well, do not swear: although I joy in thee,
Well, do not swear: although you are my joy,

I have no joy of this contract to-night:
I take no joy in this agreement tonight:

It is too rash, too unadvised, too sudden,
It is too rash, too thoughtless, too sudden,

Too like the lightning, which doth cease to be
Too like the lightning, which is gone

Ere one can say 'It lightens.' Sweet, good night!
Before anyone can say "There is lightning." Sweetheart, good night!

This bud of love, by summer's ripening breath,
This bud of love, ripened by the breath of summer,

May prove a beauteous flower when next we meet.
May turn out to be a beautiful flower when we next meet.

Good night, good night! as sweet repose and rest
Good night, good night! May sweet rest and peace

Come to thy heart as that within my breast!
Come to your heart, like the peace within mine!

WORDS

110 circled orb: **circling path** · **114** idolatry: **worship of an idol** · **117** contract: **exchange of promises**

ROMEO

O, wilt thou leave me so unsatisfied?
Oh, will you leave me so unsatisfied?

JULIET

What satisfaction canst thou have to-night?
What satisfaction can you have tonight?

ROMEO

The exchange of thy love's faithful vow for mine.
The exchange of your faithful vow of love for mine.

JULIET

I gave thee mine before thou didst request it:
I gave you mine before you asked for it:

And yet I would it were to give again.
And yet I wish I still had it to give.

ROMEO

Wouldst thou withdraw it? for what purpose, love?
Would you take it back? For what reason, love?

JULIET

But to be frank, and give it thee again.
Only to be generous, and give it to you again.

And yet I wish but for the thing I have:
And yet I am wishing for what I already have:

My bounty is as boundless as the sea,
My generosity is as limitless as the sea,

My love as deep; the more I give to thee,
My love as deep; the more I give to you,

The more I have, for both are infinite.
The more I have, for both are endless.

I hear some noise within; dear love, adieu!
I hear some noise inside; dear love, goodbye!

Nurse calls within.

Anon, good nurse! Sweet Montague, be true.
Coming, good Nurse! Sweet Montague, be faithful.

Stay but a little, I will come again.
Wait just a little, I will come back.

Exit.

ROMEO

O blessed, blessed night! I am afeard,
Oh blessed, blessed night! I am afraid,

Being in night, all this is but a dream,
Since it is night, that all this is only a dream,

Too flattering-sweet to be substantial.
Too delightfully sweet to be real.

Re-enter JULIET, above.

WORDS

131 frank: **generous**

JULIET

Three words, dear Romeo, and good night indeed.
Three words, dear Romeo, and then good night really.

If that thy bent of love be honourable,
If the purpose of your love is honourable,

Thy purpose marriage, send me word to-morrow,
And your aim is marriage, send me word tomorrow,

By one that I'll procure to come to thee,
By someone I will arrange to come to you,

Where and what time thou wilt perform the rite,
Telling me where and when you will hold the ceremony,

And all my fortunes at thy foot I'll lay
And I will lay all my fortunes at your feet

148 And follow thee my lord throughout the world.
And follow you, my lord, throughout the world.

NURSE

Within

149 Madam!
Madam!

JULIET

150 I come, anon.—But if thou mean'st not well,
I am coming, right away. But if you do not mean well,

151 I do beseech thee—
I beg you—

NURSE

Within

Madam!
Madam!

JULIET

By and by, I come:—
In a moment, I am coming:

152 To cease thy suit, and leave me to my grief:
To stop courting me, and leave me to my grief:

153 To-morrow will I send.
Tomorrow I will send.

ROMEO

So thrive my soul,—
As I hope to save my soul—

JULIET

A thousand times good night!
A thousand times good night!

Exit.

ROMEO

A thousand times the worse, to want thy light.
A thousand times worse, to be without your light.

Love goes toward love, as schoolboys from their books,
Love goes towards love as schoolboys run from their books,

But love from love, toward school with heavy looks.
But love leaves love as they go to school, with heavy looks.

Retiring slowly.

Re-enter JULIET, above.

JULIET

Hist! Romeo, hist!—O, for a falconer's voice,
Psst! Romeo, psst! Oh, for a falconer's call,

To lure this tassel-gentle back again!
To bring this noble falcon back again!

Bondage is hoarse, and may not speak aloud;
Someone kept at home must whisper and cannot speak aloud;

Else would I tear the cave where Echo lies,
Otherwise I would split the cave where Echo lives,

And make her airy tongue more hoarse than mine
And make her airy voice more hoarse than mine

With repetition of my Romeo's name.
By repeating my Romeo's name.

Romeo!
Romeo!

ROMEO

It is my soul that calls upon my name:
It is my soul that is calling my name:

How silver-sweet sound lovers' tongues by night,
How sweet as silver lovers' voices sound at night,

Like softest music to attending ears!
Like the softest music to listening ears!

JULIET

Romeo!
Romeo!

ROMEO

My dear?
My dear?

JULIET

At what o'clock to-morrow
At what time tomorrow

Shall I send to thee?
Shall I send to you?

ROMEO

At the hour of nine.
At nine o'clock.

WORDS

159 tassel-gentle: **male falcon, a noble bird** · **160** Bondage is hoarse: **one kept at home must whisper** · **161** Echo: **a nymph who could only repeat others' words**

JULIET

I will not fail: 'tis twenty years till then.
I will not fail: it is twenty years until then.

I have forgot why I did call thee back.
I have forgotten why I called you back.

ROMEO

Let me stand here till thou remember it.
Let me stand here until you remember it.

JULIET

I shall forget, to have thee still stand there,
I will keep forgetting, so that you go on standing there,

Remembering how I love thy company.
Remembering only how I love your company.

ROMEO

And I'll still stay, to have thee still forget,
And I will keep staying, so that you go on forgetting,

Forgetting any other home but this.
Forgetting any home but this one.

JULIET

'Tis almost morning; I would have thee gone:
It is almost morning; I want you gone:

And yet no farther than a wanton's bird,
And yet no farther than a spoilt child's pet bird,

Who lets it hop a little from her hand,
Which she lets hop a little way from her hand,

Like a poor prisoner in his twisted gyves,
Like a poor prisoner in his twisted chains,

And with a silk thread plucks it back again,
And then pulls back again with a silk thread,

So loving-jealous of his liberty.
So lovingly jealous of its freedom.

ROMEO

I would I were thy bird.
I wish I were your bird.

JULIET

Sweet, so would I:
Sweetheart, so do I:

Yet I should kill thee with much cherishing.
Yet I would kill you with too much loving care.

Good night, good night! parting is such sweet sorrow
Good night, good night! Parting is such sweet sorrow

That I shall say good night till it be morrow.
That I shall go on saying good night until it is morning.

Exit.

WORDS
180 gyves: **chains, shackles**

ROMEO

Sleep dwell upon thine eyes, peace in thy breast!
May sleep rest on your eyes, and peace in your heart!

Would I were sleep and peace, so sweet to rest!
I wish I were sleep and peace, to rest so sweetly!

Hence will I to my ghostly father's cell,
From here I will go to my spiritual father's cell,

His help to crave and my dear hap to tell.
To ask for his help and tell him my good fortune.

Exit.

WORDS
189 ghostly father's: **priest's (ghostly means spiritual)** · **190** hap: **good fortune**

Critical note

What is the significance of the balcony scene in Romeo and Juliet?

Critical note · about 300 words

✓ **Answer.** The balcony scene (2.2) turns a meeting into a promise of marriage. It shows the power of the lovers' feeling, Juliet's honesty and courage, and the danger and haste that will destroy them.

First, it shows love through light. Romeo sees Juliet as the dawn: “It is the east, and Juliet is the sun!” (2.2.3). She is a “bright angel” (2.2.26) above him. Even in darkness, she is the light of his world.

Second, Juliet questions the feud. Not knowing that Romeo hears, she says the quarrel is only a word: “’Tis but thy name that is my enemy;” (2.2.38). A rose would smell as sweet by any other name, and Romeo would be as dear by another.

Third, Juliet is frank and practical. Once overheard, she drops pretence: “but farewell compliment!” (2.2.89). She asks him directly, “Dost thou love me?” (2.2.90), and it is she who proposes marriage: “send me word to-morrow,” (2.2.144).

Fourth, the scene is shadowed by danger and speed. Juliet warns that her kinsmen “will murder thee” (2.2.70), and Romeo would rather die than live without her love (2.2.77-78). Juliet fears that the vow is “Too like the lightning” (2.2.119), gone in a moment, which is a warning that the play fulfils.

William Hazlitt, in Characters of Shakespear’s Plays (R. Hunter and C. and J. Ollier, 1817), wrote, “It would be hard to say which of the two garden scenes is the finest”, meaning this scene and the parting at dawn in Act 3, Scene 5. The two scenes frame the marriage: here it is promised, there it ends in separation.

Verdict: the scene is the play’s high point of joy, yet every image of light and every promise is touched by the danger of the night.

310 words

Short answers

How does Mercutio mock Romeo in Act 2, Scene 1?

5 marks · short answer

✓ **Answer.** Mercutio mocks Romeo by pretending to raise him like a spirit, with crude jokes about love. He calls him "Romeo! humours! madman! passion! lover!" (2.1.7) and asks for one sigh or rhyme. Then he conjures him by Rosaline's body, from "her scarlet lip" (2.1.18) to "quivering thigh," (2.1.19). Benvolio says love is blind and fits the dark, and Mercutio twists the idea with a bawdy joke: "If love be blind, love cannot hit the mark." (2.1.33). He does not know that Romeo has already forgotten Rosaline. The scene ends with Romeo's reply, which opens Act 2, Scene 2: "He jests at scars that never felt a wound." (2.2.1). Mercutio's mockery sets off the seriousness of Romeo's new love.

128 words

What does Juliet's "wherefore art thou Romeo?" speech show about her?

5 marks · short answer

✓ **Answer.** The speech shows that Juliet thinks clearly and boldly about love and the feud. "O Romeo, Romeo! wherefore art thou Romeo?" (2.2.33) means "why are you Romeo?", a Montague. She asks him to give up his name, or she will give up hers. She reasons that a name is not part of a person: "What's in a name? that which we call a rose / By any other name would smell as sweet;" (2.2.43-44). Then she offers herself completely: "Take all myself." (2.2.49). The

speech shows a girl who will put love before family, and who sees the feud as empty words. It also shows her innocence, because a name can kill in Verona.

119 words

How does the Prologue to Act 2 sum up the lovers' situation?

5 marks · short answer

✓ **Answer.** The second Prologue, again a sonnet, says that the old love has died and the new one faces danger. Romeo's love for Rosaline is gone: "Now old desire doth in his death-bed lie," (2.0.1). He and Juliet are "Alike bewitched by the charm of looks," (2.0.6), both won by sight. But the feud is a barrier: "Being held a foe, he may not have access" (2.0.9), and Juliet has even fewer chances to meet him. The sonnet ends with hope: "But passion lends them power, time means, to meet," (2.0.13). It stresses both the strength of their love and the danger around it, and it explains Romeo's climb into the orchard that follows.

121 words

COMMON MISTAKE

The mistake. Translating "wherefore art thou Romeo?" as "where are you, Romeo?" **The correction.** "Wherefore" means "why". Juliet does not know that Romeo is below. She asks why he must be Romeo, a Montague: "O Romeo, Romeo! wherefore art thou Romeo? / Deny thy father and refuse thy name;" (2.2.33-34). **Why it costs marks.** The error turns a speech about the feud into a search for a missing person, and it shows the examiner that the speech has not been understood.

Context answer

Act 2, Scene 2, lines 116 to 124

> Well, do not swear: although I joy in thee,
> I have no joy of this contract to-night:
> It is too rash, too unadvised, too sudden,
> Too like the lightning, which doth cease to be
> Ere one can say 'It lightens.' Sweet, good night!
> This bud of love, by summer's ripening breath,
> May prove a beauteous flower when next we meet.
> Good night, good night! as sweet repose and rest
> Come to thy heart as that within my breast! (2.2.116-124)

Reference to context · 200 to 250 words

✓ **Answer.**

Reference. These lines are spoken by Juliet in Act 2, Scene 2 of Romeo and Juliet by William Shakespeare. She is at her window above Capulet's orchard, and Romeo stands below.

Context. Romeo has overheard Juliet confess her love. He begins to swear by the moon, and she stops him, because the moon is "inconstant" (2.2.109). He starts again, and she interrupts.

Explanation. Juliet tells Romeo not to swear. Although he gives her joy, this exchange of promises tonight worries her. It is too hasty, too thoughtless, too sudden, like lightning, which is gone before anyone can say that it has flashed. She hopes that their love, now only a bud, will grow into a beautiful flower by the time they next meet. She says good night and wishes him the same peace that she feels.

Critical comment. The lightning simile, a comparison using "like", is the key to the play's speed: a flash of brightness that is quickly gone. The repetition of "too" shows Juliet's good sense even in love. Yet within a few lines she proposes marriage. The bud and flower image prepares for later images of flowers killed by frost, when her father finds her seemingly dead.

202 words

Objective questions

Choose one answer. Keys are at the end of the book.

21. At what hour will Juliet send to Romeo the next day?

(a) Six
(b) Nine
(c) Noon
(d) Ten

22. Match the speaker with the line:
A. "He jests at scars that never felt a wound."
B. "If love be blind, love cannot hit the mark."
C. "Blind is his love, and best befits the dark."
D. "O, swear not by the moon, th' inconstant moon,"
Speakers: 1. Benvolio
2. Juliet
3. Mercutio
4. Romeo

(a) A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2
(b) A-4, B-1, C-3, D-2
(c) A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2
(d) A-4, B-3, C-2, D-1

23. Assertion (A): Juliet tells Romeo not to swear by the moon.
Reason (R): The moon changes every month, and she fears his love may change too.

(a) Both A and R are true, and R explains A
(b) Both A and R are true, but R does not explain A
(c) A is true, but R is false
(d) A is false, but R is true

24. Put these events in the order they happen:
I. Mercutio conjures Romeo by Rosaline's eyes
II. Romeo sees light at Juliet's window
III. Juliet asks, "Dost thou love me?"
IV. Juliet asks Romeo to send word about the marriage

(a) II, I, III, IV
(b) I, III, II, IV
(c) I, II, IV, III
(d) I, II, III, IV

25. Statement I: Romeo says he climbed the orchard walls with "love's light wings".
Statement II: Juliet says that Romeo's name is part of his true self.

(a) Only I is true
(b) Only II is true
(c) Both are true
(d) Neither is true

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WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE

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